sanas South African National Accreditation System

NON-CONFORMANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND CLEARANCE REPORT

SANAS No.: **T1195**

Organisation Name: **Azuresky Laboratory**

NC Report Number: **AB21**

Area/Scope Assessed: **Management Requirements**

Assessor / Inspector / Expert: **A. Bougart**

PART 1: DETAILED OBSERVATION

At the time of the assessment, it was observed that a Complaint was received on 12/03/2026 from a client. Acknowledgement was sent to the complainant on the same day. The Client was given a response on 16/03/2026. An NC was not raised as per procedure ASMF7.18B and logged on the NCW,and no Risk analysis performed.

Signed (Representative):

Signed (Team Leader / Inspector): A. Bougart

MAJOR: [X] MINOR: [ ]

Reference No. of relevant Guide / Standard / Requirement: **ISO/IEC 17025 requirement 7.9.3**

Date: **08/04/2026**

PART 2: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

(Provide an analysis of the extent and cause of the nonconformity)

- Fundamental procedures not aligning
- Ineffective system documentation.

PART 3: CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

(Clearly indicate what corrective action was taken, and attach supportig evidence of implementation)

Immediate remediation
Revision of procedure 7.18B
Communication to personnel.

Date: 05/05/2026

Signed (Representative):

PART 4: CORRECTIVE ACTION VERIFIED AND CLEARED

(Comment on whether the corrective action is sufficient and appropriate)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

PART 5: FOLLOW-UP AT NEXT ASSESSMENT

(Comment on the implementation of the corrective actions)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

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AS004MF 07/25

BRAINSTORMING FORM

IRQ no: AB21

Brainstorming team

Tshepo Maponya
Keitumetse Maleka
Sizwe Nyambi

What went wrong? A complaint was raised by a client on 12/03/2026. Acknowledgement was sent out to the complainant on the same day, with a response given on 16/03/26. An NC was not raised as per procedure ASMF 7.18/3 and logged on NW register, and no Risk analysis performed.

Why was the internal quality process skipped?

- The staff focused entirely on the client's immediate response and neglected the internal administrative requirements

Why did the system allow the complainant to be closed without these steps?

- The complaint handling workflow did not have a mandatory link to the NC/risk register & procedure.

Why was the staff unaware of the mandatory nature of the risk analysis for every complaint?

- The non comforming work procedure became too bloated with its approach of risk analysing every non-conformance and was therefor skipped by personnel due to its unstructured nature of handling risks arising from NCs.

Reason: Procedural gap / TMS & fundamental procedures not aligning
: Ineffective system documentation.

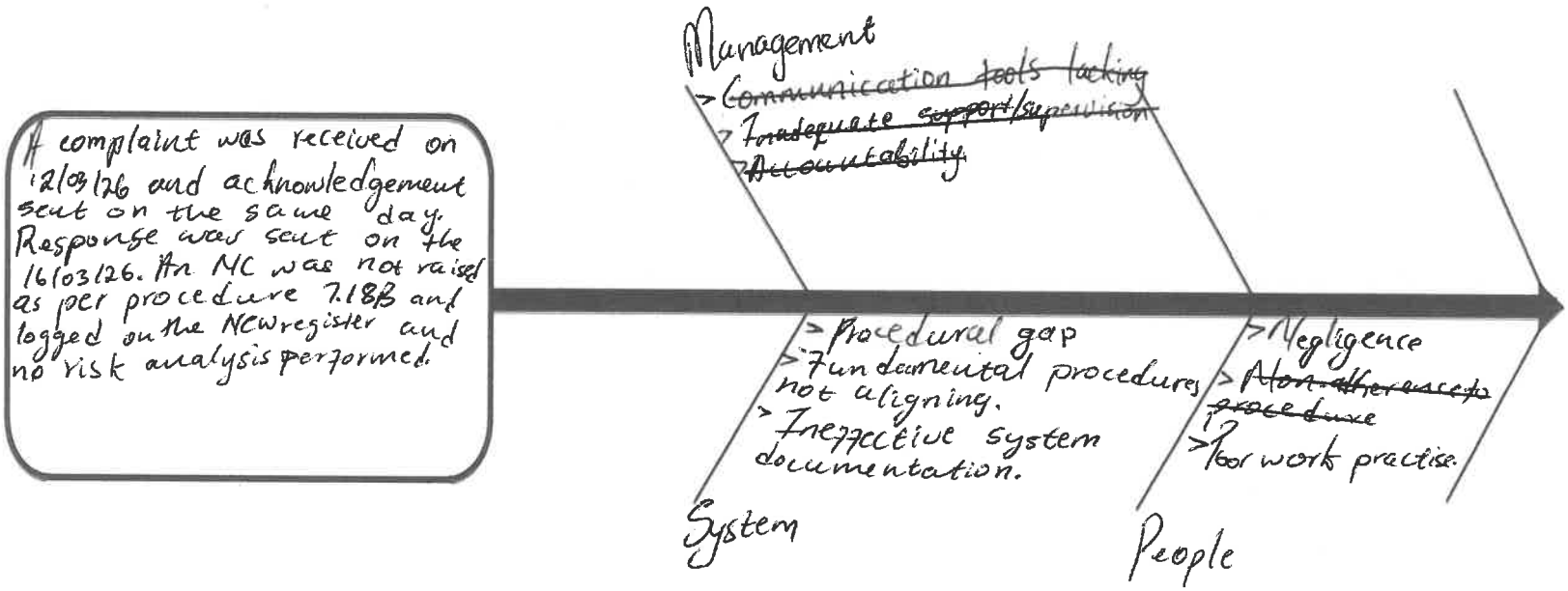
Supervisor: [signature]

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07/25

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS FORM

IRQ NO: AB21



Hponya

SUPERVISOR

AS009MF 04/26

Additional Space for NC's

IRQ no: AB21

Root cause analysis - Part 2

> Fundamental procedures not aligning

Procedure 7.18B makes mention of compliance to 7.10 procedure but does not provide how both the procedure can link to ensure the system does comply effectively & addresses both internal requirements and external requirements.

Ineffective system documentation:

Whilst the initially built system documents the use of these two procedures, it does not effectively make it mandatory ~~in ord~~ and does not offer effective structures in complaint handling & use of NCW. procedure.

Part 3 - Corrective action taken

> Immediate remediation - The complaint was fully processed internally.

> Revision of procedure 7.18B

> Communication to personnel - Memo issued to personnel on awareness to the requirements of bothe the procedures when dealing with complaints

Revision of procedure 7.18B to make it mandatory to link bothe the praedures when dealing with complaints

Supervisor:

BEFORE

	COMPLAINT AND APPEALS HANDLING PROCEDURE		
AzurESky	Document no: ASMF 7.18B		
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Extension of Application – ISO/IEC 17025 Activities

In addition to proficiency testing and certified reference material activities, this procedure shall also apply to complaints and/or appeals arising from testing, calibration, sampling, reporting of results, and customer service activities conducted under ISO/IEC 17025 accreditation.

This includes, but is not limited to, complaints or appeals relating to:

- Test or calibration results
- Sampling activities
- Method selection or application
- Report content or interpretation
- Turnaround times
- Staff conduct or competence
- Alleged nonconformities with ISO/IEC 17025 requirements

Additional Responsibilities (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Laboratory Manager:

- Ensures compliance with ISO/IEC 17025 clauses 7.9 (Complaints), 7.10 (Nonconforming Work), and 8.5 (Actions to Address Risks and Opportunities).
- Ensures records of complaints and appeals are maintained and retrievable.

Technical Manager/ Laboratory Supervisor:

- Provides technical input into investigations relating to test/calibration validity.
- Confirms whether reported results may be affected and determines the need for result recall or re-issue.

CONTROLLED DOC

AFTER

COMPLAINT AND APPEALS HANDLING PROCEDURE		
Document no: ASMF 7.18B		
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

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- Test or calibration results
- Sampling activities
- Method selection or application
- Report content or interpretation
- Turnaround times
- Staff conduct or competence
- Alleged nonconformities with ISO/IEC 17025 requirements

Upon receipt of a valid complaint, the laboratory shall open a non-conformance and record it on the NC register. An initial risk evaluation must be performed to determine if the complaint is an isolated case or a systematic failure. When sending an acknowledgement of the complaint, it must include the NC number. An investigation must be carried out, aligning with the requirements of procedure 7.10 non-conforming work. In alignment with the laboratory's performance-based model(7.10) the NC shall be monitored over a demarcated period. If no recurrence of the issue is observed during the monitoring period, the risk is deemed low, and the NC shall be closed without further action. However, if a recurrence is observed, a formal risk assessment must be conducted immediately to determine the systematic impact.

Additional Responsibilities (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Laboratory Manager:

- Ensures compliance with ISO/IEC 17025 clauses 7.9 (Complaints), 7.10 (Nonconforming Work), and 8.5 (Actions to Address Risks and Opportunities).
- Ensures records of complaints and appeals are maintained and retrievable.

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
05/2026	01	05/2029

CONTROLLED DOC

AFTER

AzurESky	**COMPLAINT AND APPEALS HANDLING PROCEDURE**
	Document no: ASMF 7.18B

Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Revision no	Contents revised	Reason for revision	Date
01	Addition of a paragraph which links the procedure to 7.10 non-conforming work procedure.	Fundamental procedure alignment to solve complaints	05/05/2026

CONTROLLED DOC

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
05/2026	01	05/2029

ASEV-01

05/26

INITIAL IMPACT EVALUATION FORM

Linked NC number: NC022h026PT

Complainant: Noko Analytical Services Witbank.

Date of assessment: 05 |05| 2026

Technical Impact Screening

Screening Question	Assessment Criteria	Findings/ Observation
Data integrity check	Does this issue potentially affect other clients' reports or previous batches?	No, client requested their reports to be structured in a way that seperates the PTs (A + B)
Equipment/Method Check	Was a specific piece of equipment or method involved that is currently in use for other samples?	No, PT has moved from having two pottles per month to having only 1 per GA.
QC Performance	Was the quality control (CRM/Duplicates) for the affected batch/sample within acceptable limits?	N/A given it was a matter of preference on the presentation of the report.

Based on the screening, is the incident a systemic failure or an isolated incident Isolated incident, no other client affected

☑ **Low Risk (Isolated Incident):** No previous recurrence in the demarcated monitoring period. No immediate threat to other technical data.

☐ **Medium/High Risk (Systemic/recurring):** Issue has occurred within the monitoring period or indicates a failure in a critical quality control aspect/system. Proceed to full Risk Assessment.

Authorized by: Tshepo Maponya

Signature: Maponya

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NON-CONFORMANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND CLEARANCE REPORT

SANAS No.:

Organisation Name: Azuresky PTY Ltd

NC Report Number: NC022/2026 PT

Area/Scope Assessed: PT reports

Assessor / Inspector / Expert: Sizi so Nyambi

PART 1: DETAILED OBSERVATION

The PT reporting process failed to ensure that result for distinct proficiency test item were evaluated & presented seperately. Specifically, performance trend graphs for month incorrectly connected z-scores from sample A & B in a single continuous data series. This resulted in the Presentation of "ghost data" on individual reports, which led to potential misrepresentation of laboratory performance and the perception of statistical bias

Signed (Representative):

Signed (Team Leader Inspector):

MAJOR: [X] MINOR: [ ]

Reference No. of relevant Guide / Standard / Requirement: ISO 17025(7.8), ISO 13528 9.9.1.

Date: 05/05/2026

PART 2: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

(Provide an analysis of the extent and cause of the nonconformity)

There was a lack of defined "report design specification" that distinguishes between some sample and categorical trending. The system prioritized visual simplicity over statistical effectiveness

PART 3: CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

(Clearly indicate what corrective action was taken, and attach supporting evidence of implementation)

- Update the statistical design to encompass the testing of two PT items within the same round (see ASMF 7.7.2.)
- Ammend clients affected report to their preference.

Date: 05/05/2026

Signed (Representative):

PART 4: CORRECTIVE ACTION VERIFIED AND CLEARED

(Comment on whether the corrective action is sufficient and appropriate)

Cleared

Date: 05/05/2026

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

PART 5: FOLLOW-UP AT NEXT ASSESSMENT

(Comment on the implementation of the corrective actions)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

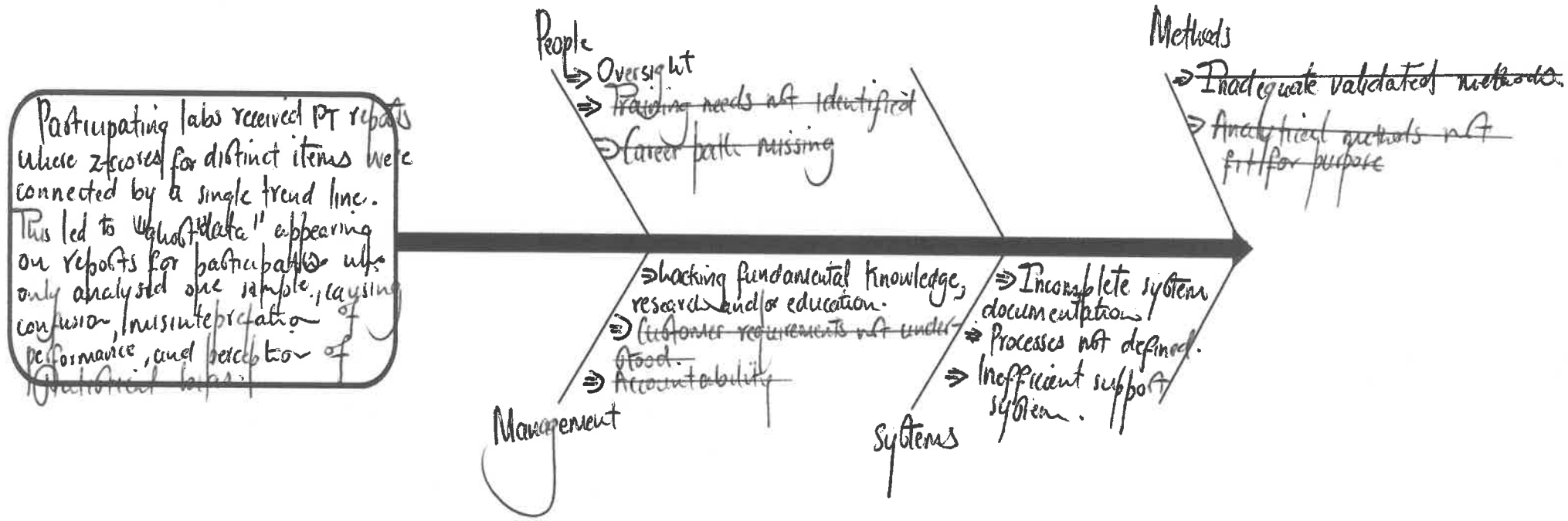
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07/25

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS FORM

IRQ NO: NC022/2026 PT & T



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SUPERVISOR

AS004MF 07/25

BRAINSTORMING FORM

IRQ no: MC022/2026 PT & T-

Brainstorming team

Sifiso Mlambi
Tshepo Maponya
Mduduzi Msibi

What went wrong? Participating laboratories received PT reports where z-scores for distinct items were connected by a single trend line. This to "ghost data" appearing on reports for participants who only analysed one sample, causing confusion, misinterpretation of performance, and the perception of statistical bias.

1. Why 1: Why did the client perceive bias & confusion? The graph joined sample A & B points, making their performance look erratic and showing data for samples they never tested.
2. Why 2: Why were sample A & B points joined on the same line? Because the reporting template was programmed to connect all points to create a "uniform" visual trend.
3. Why 3: Why was the template designed to be uniform across different samples? The lab interpreted "trending" as a continuous sequence of any result produced within the scheme, assuming that since both were coal & used the same parameters, they were interchangeable for a z-score plot.
4. Why was this Technical interpretation not caught during the design phase? The Technical review of the reporting template did not specifically evaluate the requirements of ISO 13528 (Clau 9.9.1) which states that results for each PT item must be evaluated separately.
5. Why did the Technical review miss the requirement (RC)? There was a lack of defined "report design spec" that distinguishes b/w temporal trending (same sample over time) & categorical trending (diff sample). The system prioritised visual simplicity over statistical distinctness.

Supervisor:

Before

	AzureSky		
AzurESky	Statistical Design		Document no: ASMF 7.2.2
	Compiled by:	Tshepo Maponya – Laboratory Supervisor	
	Approved by:	Sifiso Nyambi – Laboratory Manager	

2. Narrative Statistical Design Description

The AzureSky coal proficiency testing scheme is designed for quantitative determination of coal characteristics. Each participant receives one bottle of pulverized coal and reports single-determination results for the defined measurands. Statistical design ensures that performance evaluation is objective, consistent, and in line with ISO 13528:2022.

The statistical model is based on robust consensus statistics (Algorithm A), which assume that valid participant results follow an approximately normal distribution after removal of strong bias and the influence of extreme values. This model provides stable estimates of central tendency and dispersion, even in small datasets.

AzureSky verifies the reasonableness of statistical assumptions by reviewing data distributions, z-score patterns, and historical control charts from previous PT rounds. The PT provider ensures that all analyses are performed strictly according to ISO 13528 procedures, and records are maintained for SANAS review.

In cases where insufficient data are available, or when non-equivalent methods are identified, AzureSky will apply alternative approaches and transparently document these adjustments in the PT report to maintain fairness and traceability. This document shall be reviewed every three years or upon revision of ISO 13528 or ISO/IEC 17043.

After

	AzureSky	
	Statistical Design	Document no: ASMF 7.2.2
Compiled by:	Tshepo Maponya – Laboratory Supervisor	
Approved by:	Sifiso Nyambi – Laboratory Manager	

2. Narrative Statistical Design Description

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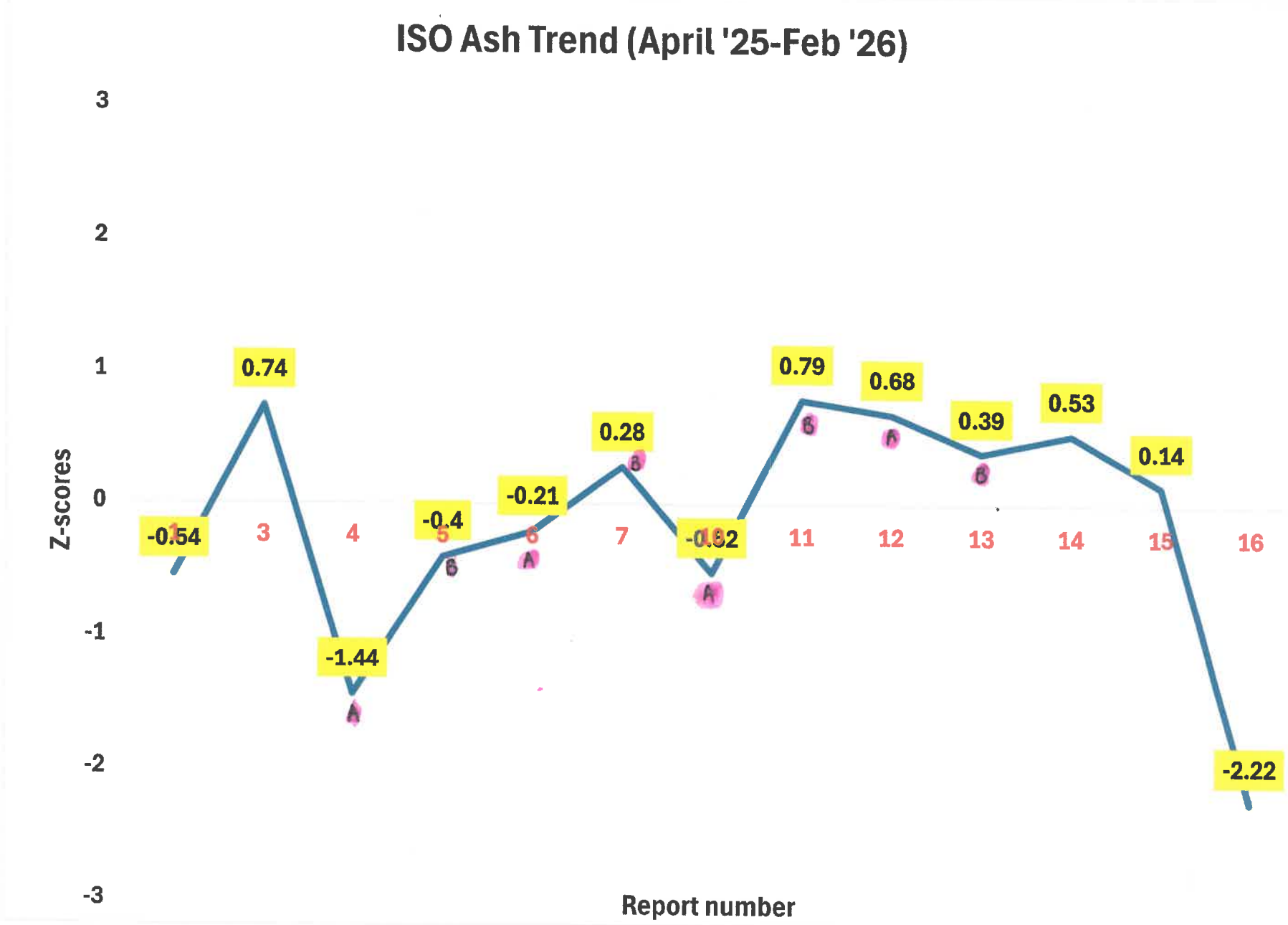
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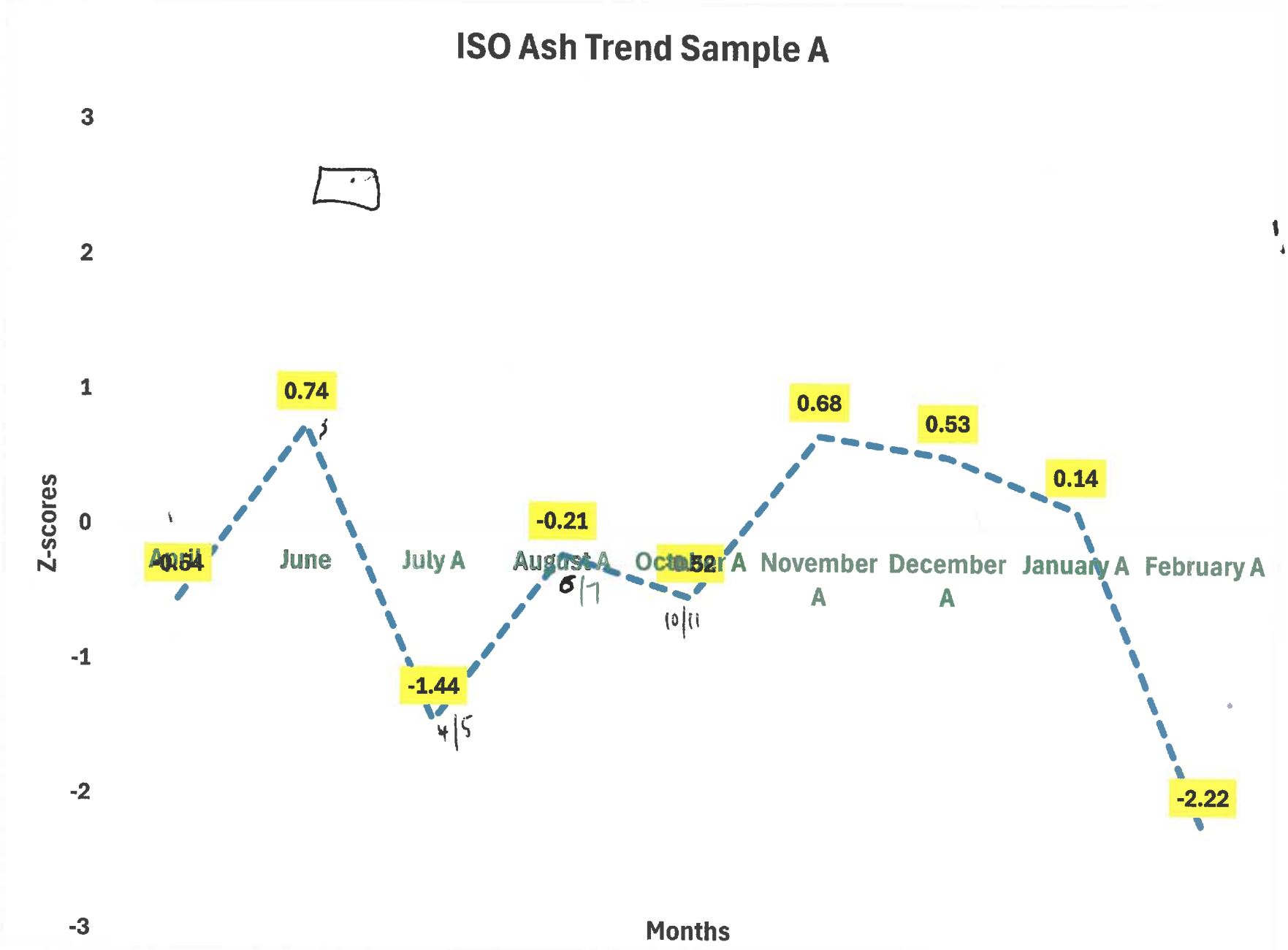
NB: If more than one sample is sent to be participants for the PT round, each PT item must have its own report. For e.g., Sample A and B are sent on the same month, Sample A shall have its own report with all the stats associated with it- this also means that sample B will also have its own. In the subsequent rounds, A will be joined with A and B joined with B (never join A with B).

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
03/2026	02	11/2028

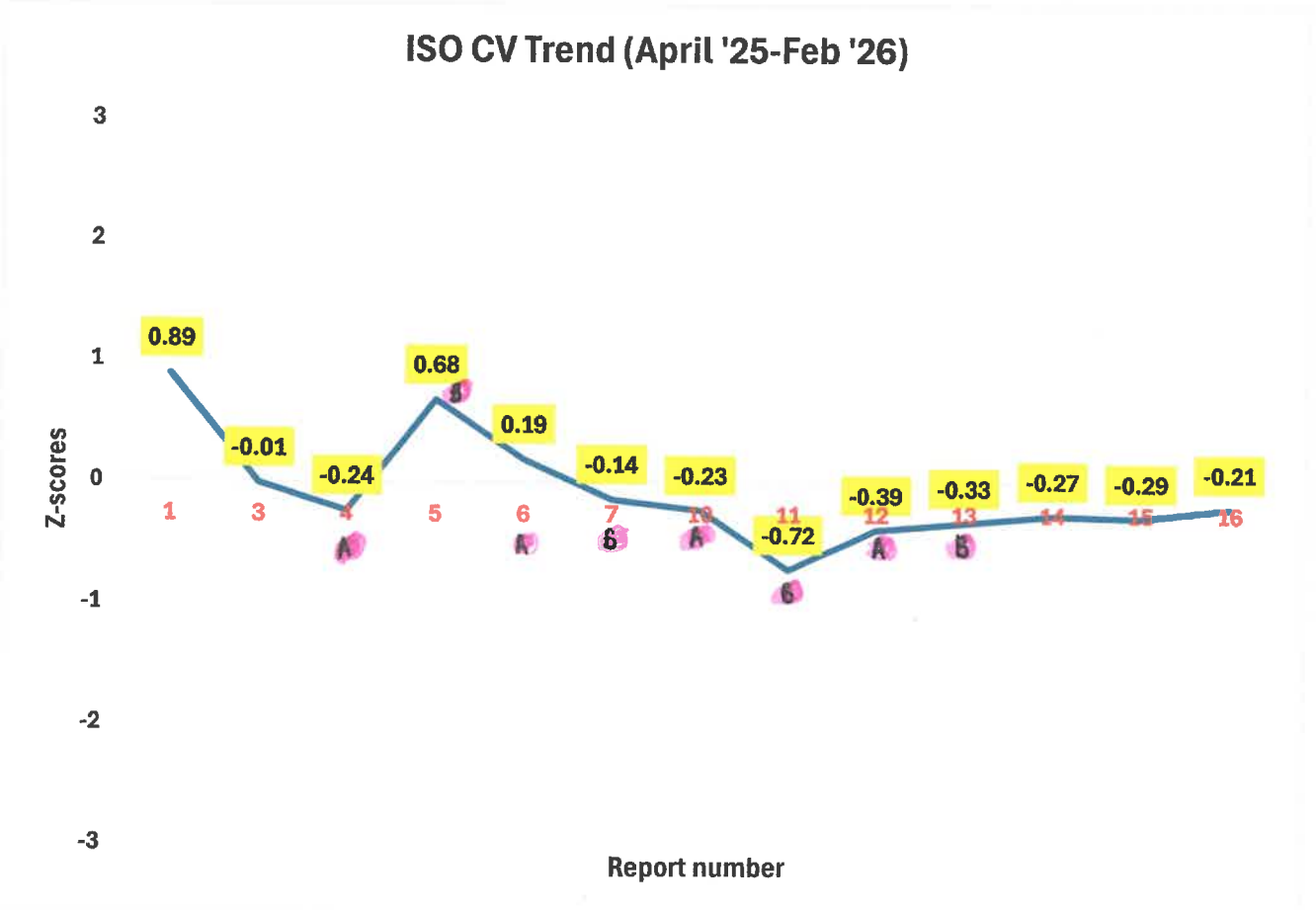
Before


ISO Ash Trend (April '25-Feb '26)
Z-scores
Report number
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
-0.54
0.74
-1.44
-0.4
-0.21
0.28
-0.82
0.79
0.68
0.39
0.53
0.14
-2.22
1
3
4
5
6
7
11
12
13
14
15
16

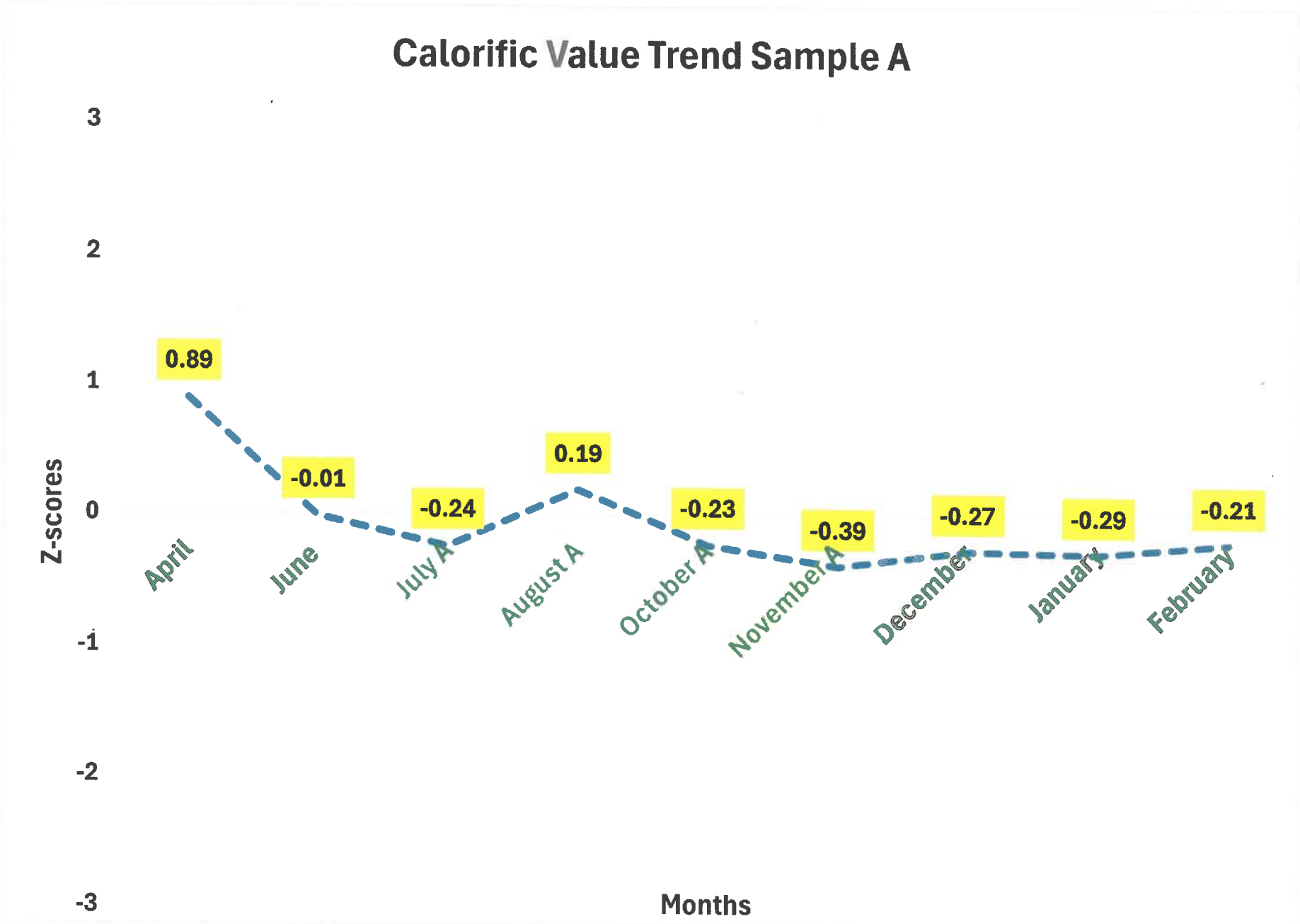
After


ISO Ash Trend Sample A
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
Z-scores
0.74
-0.21
0.68
0.53
0.14
-0.54
-1.44
-0.52
-2.22
June
July A
November A
December A
Months

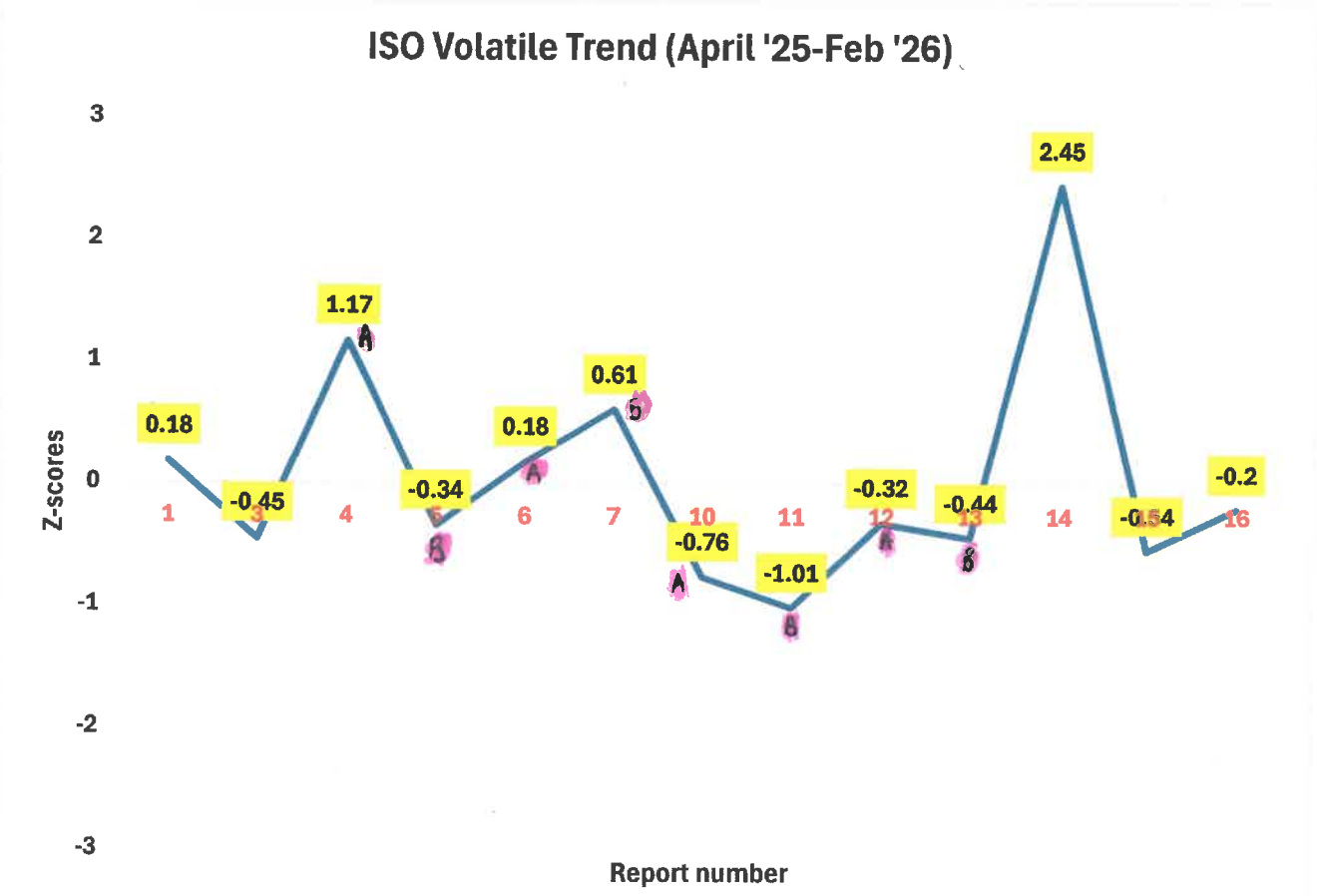
Before


ISO CV Trend (April '25-Feb '26)
Z-scores
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
0.89
-0.01
-0.24
0.68
0.19
-0.14
-0.23
-0.72
-0.39
-0.33
-0.27
-0.29
-0.21
1
3
4
5
6
7
11
12
13
16
Report number

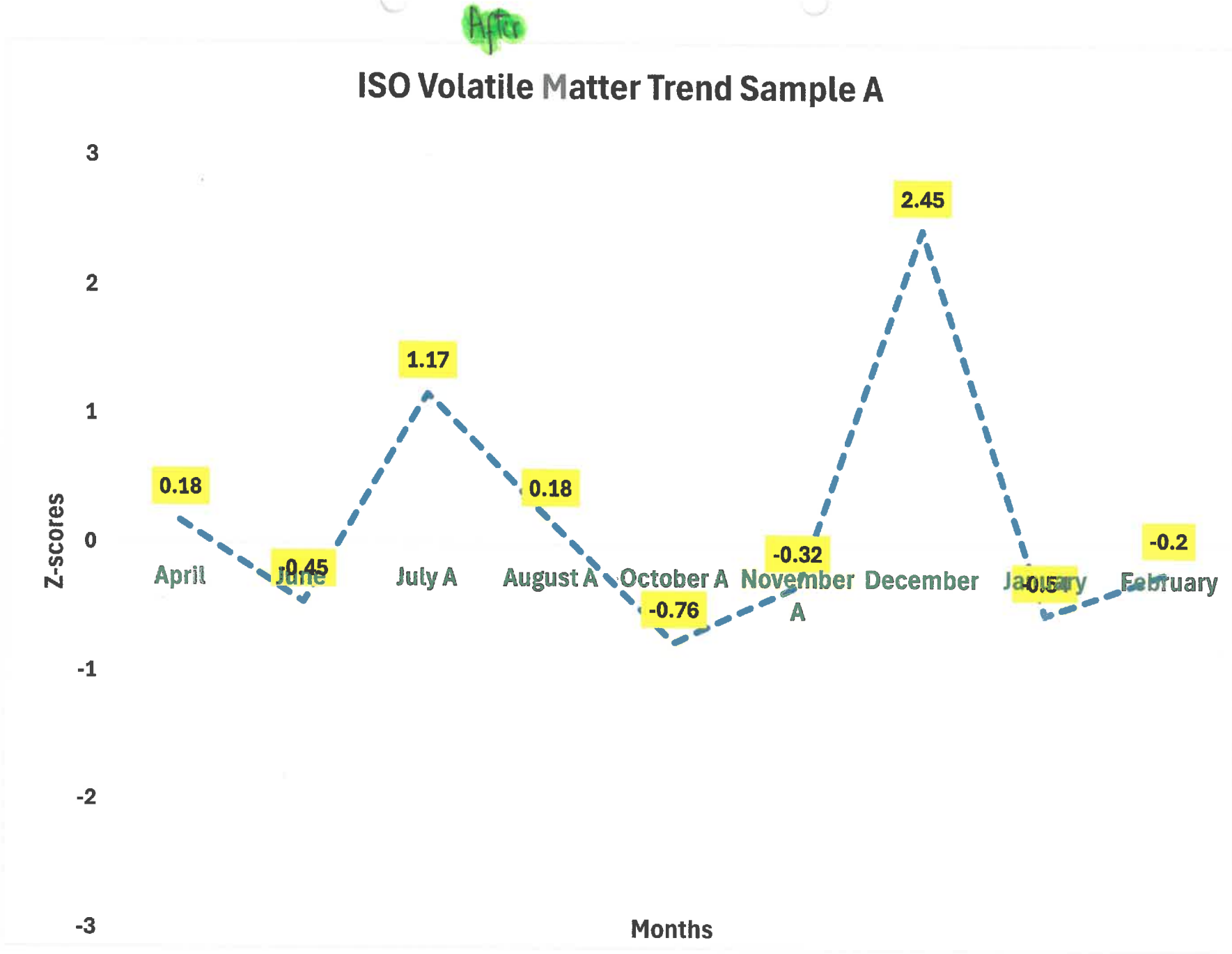
After


Calorific Value Trend Sample A
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
Z-scores
0.89
-0.01
-0.24
0.19
-0.23
-0.39
-0.27
-0.29
-0.21
April
June
July A
August A
October A
November A
December
January
February
Months

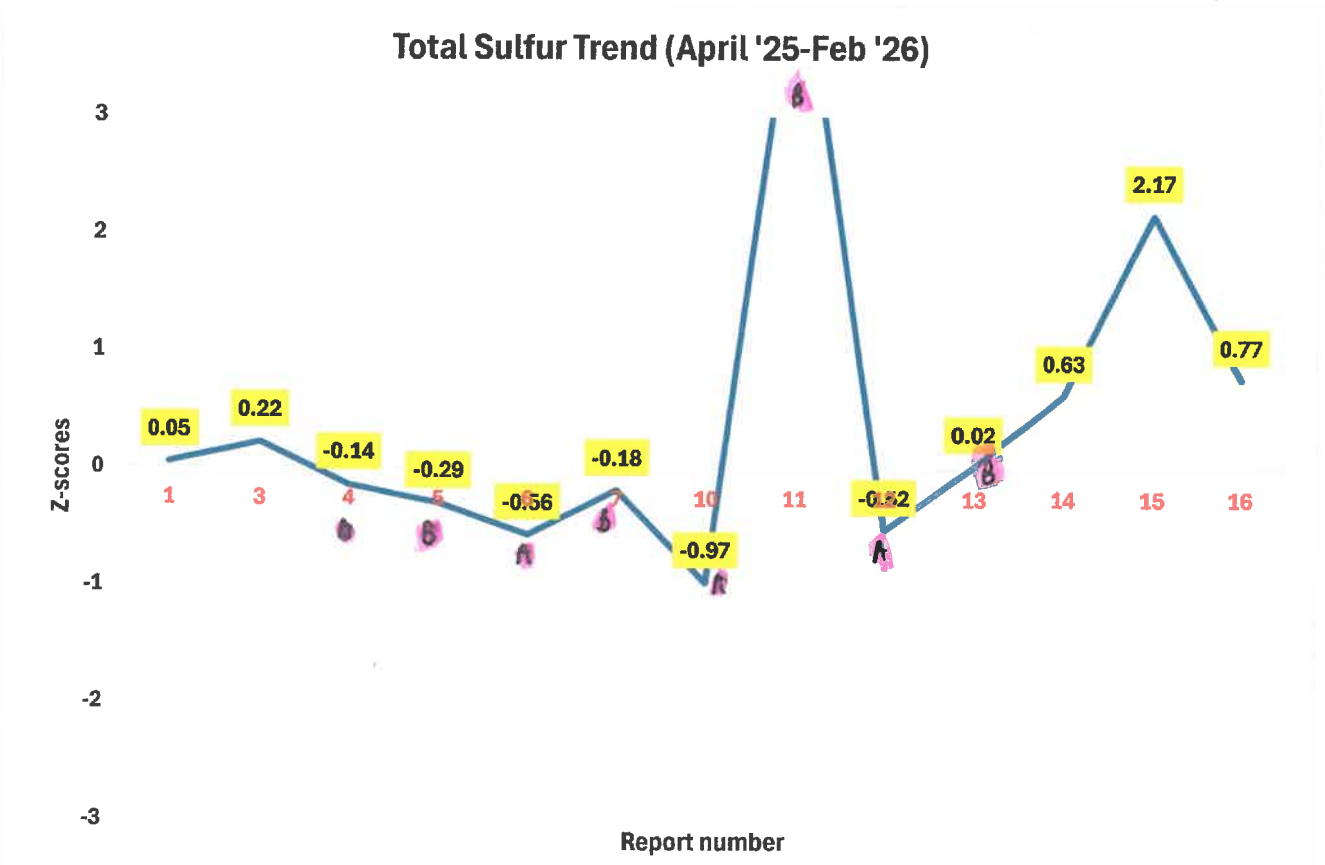
Before


ISO Volatile Trend (April '25-Feb '26)
Z-scores
Report number
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
0.18
-0.45
1.17
-0.34
0.18
0.61
-0.76
-1.01
-0.32
-0.44
2.45
-0.54
-0.2
1
3
4
5
6
7
10
11
12
13
14
16

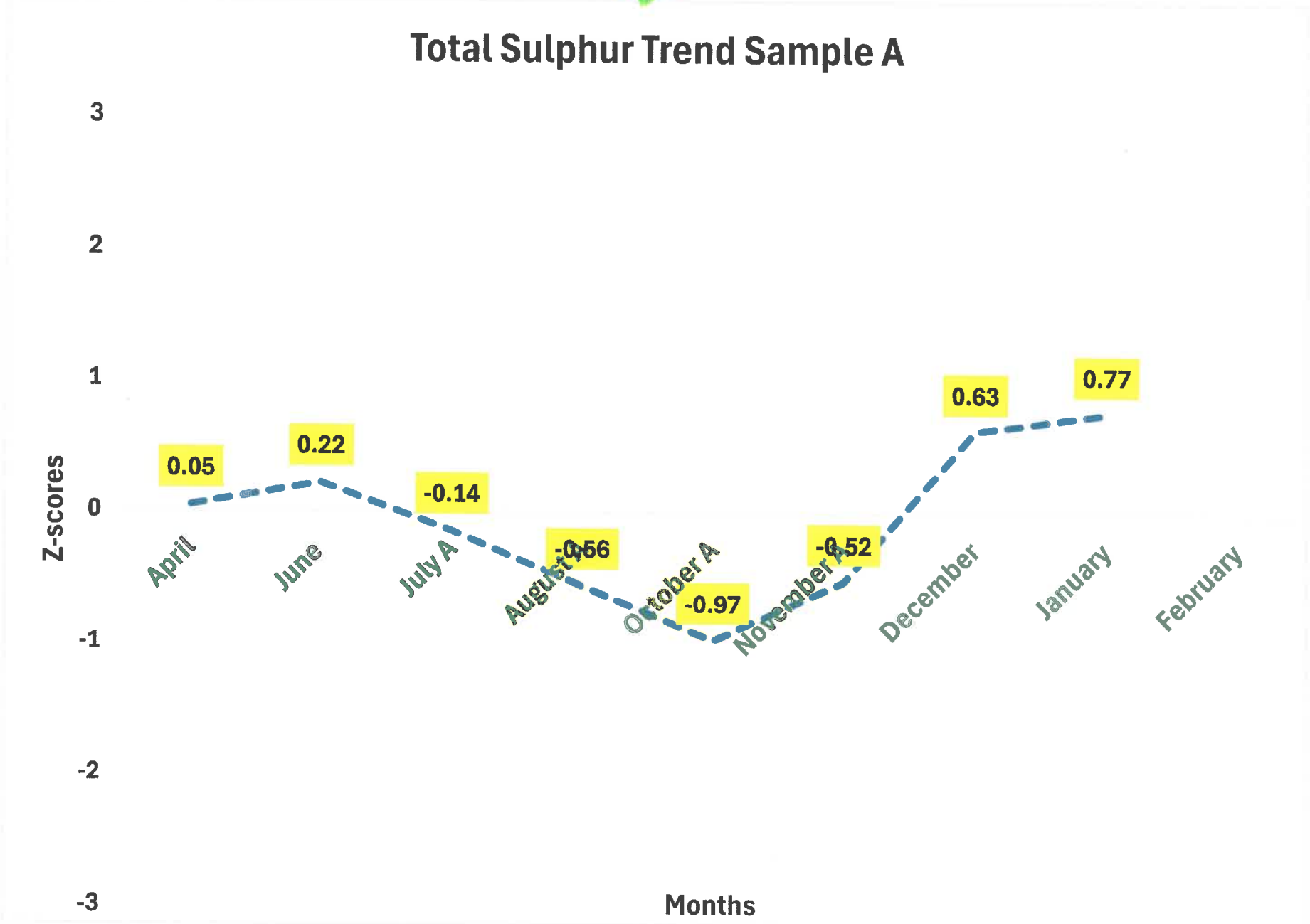
After


ISO Volatile Matter Trend Sample A
Z-scores
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
0.18
-0.45
1.17
0.18
-0.76
-0.32
2.45
-0.5
-0.2
April
June
July A
August A
October A
November A
December
January
February
Months

Before


Total Sulfur Trend (April '25-Feb '26)
Z-scores
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
0.05
0.22
-0.14
-0.29
-0.56
-0.18
-0.97
2.17
0.77
0.63
0.02
1
3
4
5
10
11
13
14
15
16
Report number

After


Total Sulphur Trend Sample A
3
2
1
0
-1
-2
-3
Z-scores
0.05
0.22
-0.14
-0.56
-0.97
-0.52
0.63
0.77
April
June
July A
August A
October A
November A
December
January
February
Months

AzurESky	**Document No.** AS008MF	**Page 1 of 1**
	Effective Date	**April 2026**
	Revision Date	**April 2029**

Title:	Memorandum	
Document by:	Azuresky Pty Ltd	**Revision No**
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi & Tshepo Maponya	**00**
Authorizing Officer: N Msibi	**Signature:**	

Department: Management

Memorandum no: 012

Position: Lab Supervisor

Date: 06/05/2026

Title: Notice of complaints handling procedure

Personel are requested that when a valid complaint has been lodged by a client, they are to adhere to requirements of procedure 7.18B Complaints. The procedure has been revised to link directly to procedure 7.10 and must therefore be used when/during investigations.

AzurESky	ATTENDANCE REGISTER		
	Document no:	Version:	Page:
	ASMF 17043-8.4.1	0	1
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	
Date:	05/05/2026		
Chair:	TMJ Mapanya	**Scribe**	
Subject:	Awareness of process of handling complaints		
Absent:			

Present	Cell Number	Designation	Signature	Email address
TMJ Mapanya	076 455 0692	Lab Supervisor		tshepomapanya10@gmail.com
K. Maleka	071 724 9031	lab analyst		Keitumetsc@azure.it.com
SB Nyambi	072 174 1852	lab Manager		Sifiso@azuresky.it.com
N. Msibi	082 786 2149	Ops Manager		nonhlanhla@azuresky.it.com